recounted his efforts at spreading awareness about the Bangladeshi refugee crisis around the world in 1971 and a memorable remark made by a labour economist at a dinner at Harvard in 1972:[52]

> Dr Patel, now that you are friendly with Bangladesh, I suppose the historical migration of Bengali Muslims into Assam and India's North-east will be resumed.' This had never occurred to me and I asked him what he meant. He told me about natural population and economic dynamics and how, under the British, a large-scale migration had taken place and this was interrupted by Partition . . . How little attention do we pay in India to history and to the understanding of geopolitical realities!

The observation was spot on. The 'displaced' of 1947 and 'refugees' of 1971 would give way to 'migrants' or more accurately 'illegal migrants' as the key phrase used to characterize human flows between Bangladesh and India in subsequent decades, a theme we will return to in the final chapter.

Tibet

On the road between Mysore and Madikeri in south India lies a settlement so removed in appearance from its neighbours that it can stun the lay traveller. Bylakuppe is a place replete with prayer flags, momos, pagodas and men in deep red robes. It is home to around 10,000 people and is the largest Tibetan settlement in India with schools, health facilities and a monastery called Namdroling. It also proudly displays posters of Tenzin Gyatso, better known as the fourteenth Dalai Lama, the spiritual leader of Buddhist Tibetans. The Dalai Lama himself lives 3000 kilometres north, in picturesque Dharamsala in Himachal Pradesh, the headquarters of the Central Tibetan Administration (CTA), a parliament-in-exile. Some 3000 kilometres to the east lies its inspiration—Lhasa—across the Himalayas, nestled within the 'roof of the world', the Tibetan Plateau, governed by China.

When the roof began to splinter in the 1950s with Chinese occupation, it was not evident to the Tibetans that their young spiritual leader would spend his life in exile. A failed uprising in March 1959 led the twenty-three-year-old Dalai Lama to make a dramatic escape from Lhasa, disguised